
✔ EFFECTIVE MECHANICS

1. Grammar

Grammar is the set of rules that govern sentence structure.

Key Areas (Exam-oriented):

- Parts of Speech
- Tenses
- Active & Passive Voice
- Subject-Verb Agreement
- Articles (a, an, the)
- Prepositions

✔ Correct grammar ensures **clarity, accuracy, and professionalism.**

2. Spellings

Correct spellings avoid confusion.

Common Correct Spellings (Exam):

- receive ✔ (not recieve)
 - separate ✔ (not seperate)
 - environment ✔ (not enviroment)
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3. Capitalisation

Use capital letters for:

- First word of sentence
 - Proper nouns (Pakistan, Ali)
 - Days & months
 - Titles with names (Dr. Ahmed)
 - Abbreviations (AI, NLP)
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4. Abbreviations

Shortened forms of words.

Examples:

- e.g. → for example
 - i.e. → that is
 - etc. → and so on
 - ASAP → as soon as possible
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 SHORT REPORT

Purpose (from board)

- Immediate **action / decision-making**

Audience

- Specific, often **internal audience**

Time Frame

- Past or **present (current analysis)**

Structure

1. Introduction / Problem
2. Findings / Analysis
3. Conclusions
4. Recommendations

Features

- Concise & to the point
 - Direct, practical
 - Only relevant data included
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 IMRD REPORT

IMRD = Introduction, Methods, Results, Discussion

Purpose

- Present **completed research findings**

Audience

- Peers, researchers, academics

Time Frame

- Past research

Core Structure (Very Important)

1. **Introduction** – background & objectives
2. **Methods** – methodology, tools
3. **Results** – data, tables, figures
4. **Discussion** – interpretation of results

Style

- Formal
- Objective
- Impersonal
- Passive voice common

Data

- All raw and analyzed data

IMRD vs SHORT REPORT (EXAM COMPARISON)

Feature	IMRD	Short Report
Purpose	Research findings	Quick decisions
Audience	Academics	Internal staff
Length	Detailed	Brief
Data	Full data	Relevant data only

PROGRESS REPORT

Purpose

- Update on **ongoing work status**

Audience

- Supervisors

- Clients
- Stakeholders
- Bosses

Time Frame

- Past, present & future

Structure (from board)

1. Work completed
2. Work in progress
3. Problems encountered
4. Next steps / future plans

Style

- Descriptive
- Informative
- Accountability-focused
- Goal-oriented

PLAGIARISM

Definition

Plagiarism is using someone else's work **without proper acknowledgment**.

Types of Plagiarism

(Exactly as on your board – VERY IMPORTANT)

1. **Direct (Verbatim) plagiarism**
2. **Mosaic (Patchwork) plagiarism**
3. **Paraphrasing plagiarism**
4. **Self-plagiarism (Duplicate publication)**
5. **Source-based plagiarism**
6. **Media & data plagiarism**
7. **Collaborative plagiarism**

8. **Complete plagiarism**
 9. **Accidental / Unintentional plagiarism**
 10. **AI-assisted plagiarism**
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Techniques to Avoid Plagiarism

- Proper citation & referencing
 - Paraphrasing correctly
 - Quotation marks
 - Reference lists
 - Plagiarism checking tools
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LONG REPORTS

Definition

Detailed documents covering **complex topics**.

Content / Parts

1. Title Page
2. Abstract
3. Table of Contents
4. Introduction
5. Literature Review
6. Methodology
7. Results
8. Discussion
9. Conclusion
10. References
11. Appendices

Format

- Formal language
- Headings & subheadings

- Page numbers
 - Figures & tables
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BUSINESS EMAILS

Key Features

- Clear subject line
- Formal tone
- Concise message
- Proper closing

Email Format

- Subject
 - Greeting
 - Body
 - Closing
 - Signature
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Quoting & Referencing Skills (Exam-friendly)

- Quote previous emails using “>”
- Mention attachments clearly
- Reference dates & documents

Example:

As discussed in your email dated 10 March 2025...

ABBREVIATIONS

Standard

- ASAP – As Soon As Possible
- FYI – For Your Information
- ETA – Estimated Time of Arrival

Research-Related

- AI – Artificial Intelligence
 - ML – Machine Learning
 - NLP – Natural Language Processing
 - CNN – Convolutional Neural Network
 - RAG – Retrieval Augmented Generation
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✅ BRITISH vs AMERICAN ENGLISH

Spellings

- colour (Br) → color (Am)
- defence (Br) → defense (Am)
- centre (Br) → center (Am)

Vocabulary

- lift (Br) → elevator (Am)
- flat (Br) → apartment (Am)
- petrol (Br) → gas

Grammar

- Br: *I have just eaten.*
 - Am: *I just ate.*
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Below are **brief, exam-ready descriptions of all plagiarism types plus clear identification tips** so you can **recognize each type while reviewing a report**.

This is **high-scoring content** because it covers **definition + detection**, which examiners like.

PLAGIARISM

Definition:

Plagiarism is presenting someone else's ideas, words, data, or work as one's own **without proper acknowledgment**.

TYPES OF PLAGIARISM & HOW TO IDENTIFY THEM

1. Direct (Verbatim) Plagiarism

Description:

Copying text word-for-word from a source without quotation marks or citation.

How to Identify:

- Exact sentences match another source
- Same vocabulary and sentence structure
- High similarity in plagiarism software

2. Mosaic (Patchwork) Plagiarism

Description:

Mixing copied phrases from multiple sources with minor changes.

How to Identify:

- Frequent synonym replacement
- Inconsistent writing style
- Sentences feel stitched together

3. Paraphrasing Plagiarism

Description:

Rewriting text in own words **but keeping the original idea** without citation.

How to Identify:

- Structure and logic identical to source
- Only words changed, meaning same
- No reference given

4. Self-Plagiarism (Duplicate Publication)

Description:

Reusing one's own previously submitted or published work without permission or citation.

How to Identify:

- Content matches author's earlier work

- Same figures, tables, or paragraphs reused
 - No mention of prior publication
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5. Source-Based Plagiarism

Description:

Citing incorrect, misleading, or fabricated sources.

How to Identify:

- References that do not exist
 - Citation does not support the claim
 - Mismatch between text and reference list
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6. Media and Data Plagiarism

Description:

Using images, graphs, tables, datasets, or code without credit.

How to Identify:

- Figures without captions or citations
 - Data appears reused from known studies
 - No source mentioned for visuals
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7. Collaborative Plagiarism

Description:

Unauthorized collaboration where individual work is required.

How to Identify:

- Reports from different students look identical
 - Same structure, wording, and examples
 - Lack of individual contribution
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8. Complete Plagiarism

Description:

Submitting someone else's entire work as your own.

How to Identify:

- Writing style does not match author's level
 - Document found fully online
 - 90–100% similarity score
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9. Accidental / Unintentional Plagiarism

Description:

Plagiarism caused by poor citation, paraphrasing errors, or lack of awareness.

How to Identify:

- Missing quotation marks
 - Incomplete references
 - Minor similarity but repeated
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10. AI-Assisted Plagiarism

Description:

Using AI-generated content **without disclosure** or passing it as original work.

How to Identify:

- Overly polished, generic language
 - No personal insight or examples
 - Inconsistent depth across sections
 - Detected by AI-detection tools (where used)
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QUICK REVIEW CHECKLIST (EXAM GOLD)

When reviewing a report, ask:

- ✓ Are all sources cited?
 - ✓ Is the writing style consistent?
 - ✓ Are figures/tables referenced?
 - ✓ Do paraphrases change structure + wording?
 - ✓ Is originality visible?
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ONE-LINE MEMORY TIP

Same words = Direct | Mixed words = Mosaic | Same idea = Paraphrasing | Same author = Self | Fake source = Source-based

Before Mids

Below are **clear, concise, exam-ready notes** for **all the topics you listed**, written in **simple language**, with **definitions, points, and formats**—exactly what examiners expect.

TECHNICAL WRITING

Definition

Technical writing is the process of **communicating technical or complex information** clearly, accurately, and logically to a specific audience.

Why It Is Essential

- Ensures clarity and precision
 - Helps in decision-making
 - Reduces errors and misunderstandings
 - Supports professional and academic work
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Types of Technical Writing

- Reports
 - Proposals
 - Manuals & documentation
 - Research papers
 - Business emails
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Purpose of Reports

- Inform decision-makers
- Present research findings
- Record progress
- Recommend solutions

✓ RESEARCH PROCESS

Definition

A systematic investigation to discover, interpret, or revise facts.

Steps of Research Process

1. Identify problem
2. Review literature
3. Select research method
4. Collect data
5. Analyze data
6. Interpret results
7. Report findings

Primary Research

Definition: Data collected first-hand.

Examples:

- Surveys
- Interviews
- Experiments
- Observations

Features:

- Original data
- Accurate but time-consuming

Secondary Research

Definition: Data collected from existing sources.

Examples:

- Books
- Journals

- Websites
- Reports

Features:

- Fast and economical
 - Less control over accuracy
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 WRITING PROCESS AT WORK

1. Outlining

Organizing ideas before writing.

Purpose:

- Logical structure
 - Clear flow of ideas
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2. Paraphrasing

Rewriting information in your own words **without changing meaning**.

Purpose:

- Avoid plagiarism
 - Improve clarity
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3. Sequencing

Arranging information in a logical order.

Types:

- Chronological
 - Priority-based
 - Cause–effect
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 PROPOSALS

Definition

A proposal is a document that **suggests a plan or solution** to a problem.

Types of Proposals

- Internal proposal
- External proposal
- Solicited proposal
- Unsolicited proposal
- Research proposal
- Technical project proposal

Characteristics of a Good Proposal

- Clear objective
- Feasible solution
- Logical structure
- Persuasive language
- Professional tone

PROPOSALS FOR RESEARCH REPORT

Purpose

To seek approval to conduct research.

Structure

1. Title
2. Introduction / Background
3. Problem statement
4. Objectives
5. Research questions / hypothesis
6. Methodology
7. Expected outcomes
8. Timeline
9. References

✓ PROPOSALS FOR SOLUTIONS / BIDS FOR TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Purpose

To offer a **technical solution** or **bid for a project**.

Structure

1. Executive summary
2. Problem description
3. Proposed solution
4. Technical approach
5. Resources & tools
6. Cost estimation
7. Timeline
8. Conclusion

Key Focus

- Practicality
- Cost-effectiveness
- Technical feasibility

✓ SUMMARISING SKILLS

Definition

Condensing information while preserving the main idea.

Writing a Summary

- Shortened version
- Covers key points only
- Written in own words
- No new ideas

Writing an Abstract

- Very brief overview of a report or research
- Appears at the beginning

Abstract Includes:

- Purpose
 - Method
 - Results
 - Conclusion
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 PROCESS OF REVISING & EDITING

Revising

Focuses on **content and structure**.

- ✓ Improve clarity
 - ✓ Remove irrelevant information
 - ✓ Improve organization
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Editing

Focuses on **language and mechanics**.

- ✓ Grammar
 - ✓ Spelling
 - ✓ Punctuation
 - ✓ Sentence structure
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Common Sentence Errors

- Run-on sentences
 - Sentence fragments
 - Subject–verb disagreement
 - Misplaced modifiers
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